

CBC & CBE RESOURCES • FREE TOOLKIT

CBC Lesson Planning & Strand Alignment Toolkit

A practical step-by-step toolkit that helps Kenyan teachers translate curriculum designs into learner-centred lessons by seamlessly aligning strands, sub-strands, specific learning outcomes, core competencies, values, formative assessments, and differentiated learner support.

FORMAT	ESTIMATED TIME	TARGET AUDIENCE	PUBLICATION VERSION
Toolkit (PDF)	30 Mins	All Educators (Grades 1-9)	Version 1.0 (2026 Edition)

SECTION 1

Introduction & Core Principles of CBC Lesson Planning

The Kenyan Competency-Based Curriculum (CBC) marks a fundamental paradigm shift from rote memorisation to active, learner-centred discovery and demonstration of competence. In CBC, a lesson is not an isolated event where a teacher lectures from a textbook; it is a carefully structured, guided learning experience where learners engage, construct meaning, collaborate, and apply knowledge in authentic contexts.

The Core CBC Equation:

Strand & Sub-strand → Specific Learning Outcomes (SLOs) → Active Learning Experiences → Formative Assessment Rubrics

Key Competencies Embedded in Every Lesson

Every CBC lesson plan must intentionally nurture the 7 Core Competencies identified in the Kenya National Curriculum Policy Framework:

Core Competency	What Learners Do in Class	Observable Classroom Evidence
1. Communication & Collaboration	Group dialogue, peer debates, joint problem solving, active listening.	Learners actively exchange ideas, take turns speaking, and produce joint outputs.
2. Critical Thinking & Problem Solving	Analyzing data, evaluating claims, finding local solutions to real challenges.	Learners formulate questions, test hypotheses, and justify conclusions with evidence.
3. Creativity & Imagination	Generating novel ideas, creating models, writing original stories, artistic expression.	Learners produce unique artifacts, design novel experiments, or suggest alternative approaches.
4. Citizenship	Respecting diversity, community stewardship, democratic decision-making.	Learners follow classroom ground rules, respect differing viewpoints, and maintain clean spaces.
5. Digital Literacy	Using digital devices safely, conducting research, creating digital presentations.	Learners navigate educational applications responsibly, search safely, and evaluate sources.
6. Learning to Learn	Self-reflection, setting learning goals, identifying personal knowledge gaps.	Learners self-assess using rubrics, monitor their own progress, and seek constructive feedback.
7. Self-Efficacy	Taking initiative, building self-confidence, persevering through challenges.	Learners volunteer presentations, attempt challenging tasks, and demonstrate resilience.

SECTION 2

The Outcome–Unpacking Tool: Formulating Rigorous SLOs

Specific Learning Outcomes (SLOs) are clear, observable statements of what the learner should be able to do by the end of the lesson. A strong SLO uses precise, measurable action verbs and specifies the context and criterion for success.

The ABCD Anatomy of a CBC Learning Outcome

Component	Definition	Exemplar Phrase
A — Audience	Who is doing the learning?	<i>"The learner..."</i>
B — Behaviour	What observable action or skill is demonstrated? (Measurable verb)	<i>"...classify local soil samples into clay, loam, and sand..."</i>
C — Condition	Under what setting, tools, or stimuli does the learning happen?	<i>"...using hand lenses, water saturation tests, and tactile observation..."</i>
D — Degree	What is the acceptable standard or level of mastery?	<i>"...correctly identifying at least three physical properties of each type."</i>

Action Verbs: Verbs to Use vs. Verbs to Avoid

✓ Observable & Measurable Verbs:

- Identify, list, name, label
- Explain, describe, summarize
- Construct, model, sketch, write
- Analyze, compare, differentiate
- Evaluate, critique, justify

✗ Vague & Non-Measurable Verbs (Avoid):

- "Understand" (Cannot be directly observed)
- "Know" (Subjective and vague)
- "Appreciate" (Attitudinal, hard to measure in 40 mins)
- "Learn about" (Process, not an outcome)
- "Be familiar with" (Lacks demonstrable performance)

Complete Exemplar SLO:

"By the end of the lesson, the learner should be able to calculate the perimeter of composite rectangular shapes using metric rulers with at least 80% accuracy in collaborative pairs."

SECTION 3

The 5-Phase Learner-Centred Lesson Sequencing Guide

An effective 40-minute CBC lesson moves fluidly from engagement to student-led exploration, conceptual clarification, application, and reflective closure.

Phase & Time	Teacher Facilitation Activities	Learner Active Experiences
1. Hook & Intro (5 mins)	Poses a provocative real-life question, shows a curiosity object, or links to previous strand concepts.	Observes, predicts, shares prior knowledge, responds to driving inquiry questions.
2. Guided Exploration (12 mins)	Organizes heterogeneous groups, distributes inquiry materials/devices, sets clear safety/collaborative ground rules.	Hands-on exploration: experiments, sorts realia, collects field observations, searches digital resources.
3. Co-Construction (10 mins)	Guides group representatives to report findings, synthesizes key vocabulary on whiteboard, clarifies misconceptions.	Presents group findings, justifies reasoning, notes peer insights, formulates general rules.
4. Independent Application (8 mins)	Circulates with formative assessment checklist, offers differentiated coaching, logs rubric levels.	Individually solves a contextual challenge, creates an artifact, writes reflections in exercise books.
5. Closure & Assessment (5 mins)	Conducts quick exit-ticket check, prompts self-reflection, outlines extended community activity.	Completes exit ticket (3 things learned, 1 question), reflects on group collaboration.

Inclusion & Differentiated Learning Support Checklist

Every classroom has neurodiverse and varied-ability learners. Use this checklist during planning:

- ✓ **Visual Accommodations:** High-contrast worksheets, enlarged text, visual diagrams, tactile models for visually impaired learners.
- ✓ **Auditory Support:** Clear step-by-step verbal repetition, written instructions on the board, peer study buddy support.
- ✓ **Kinesthetic & Motor:** Hands-on manipulatives, gross/fine motor adaptations, movement breaks during transition phases.
- ✓ **Advanced / Fast Finishers:** Higher-order extension challenges (e.g., "Design an experiment to test if this applies to liquids").
- ✓ **Emerging Learners:** Scaffolding sentence frames, graphic organizers, peer tutoring, and focused small-group teacher conferences.

The Master CBC Lesson Plan Template & Worked Example

INSTRUCTIFY KENYA • COMPETENCY-BASED CURRICULUM LESSON PLAN

School: Nairobi Junior
Secondary

Grade / Level:
Grade 7

Date: 18 Sep
2026

Time / Roll: 09:00 - 09:40 (42
Learners)

Learning Area: Integrated Science

Strand: Living Things & Their Environment

Sub-strand: Mixtures, Elements and Compounds — Separation of Insoluble Solids

**Specific Learning
Outcomes:**

By the end of the lesson, the learner should be able to:

1. *Identify* at least three everyday mixtures of insoluble solids and liquids in local household environments.
2. *Perform* gravity filtration and decantation using local sand, water, and cloth filters safely.
3. *Demonstrate* collaborative teamwork and environmental stewardship when disposing of separated materials.

Core Competencies:

Communication & Collaboration, Critical Thinking & Problem Solving, Digital Literacy.

Values:

Respect, Responsibility, Integrity, Unity.

**Pertinent & Contemporary
Issues (PCIs):**

Environmental conservation (water sanitization and safe disposal of household residues).

Learning Resources:

Beakers/clear plastic cups, sand, muddy water, filter funnels, cotton cloth, digital tablet camera for recording steps.

Formative Assessment 4-Level Performance Rubric

Exceeding Expectation (4)

Correctly filters mixture, explains underlying physical principles of particle size, and designs a multi-stage improvised filter.

Meeting Expectation (3)

Correctly sets up filtration apparatus, separates sand from water completely, and follows classroom safety procedures.

Approaching Expectation (2)

Separates sand with minor residue in filtrate; requires peer or teacher prompt to secure the funnel/cloth firmly.

Below Expectation (1)

Unable to assemble filtration setup; mixes materials improperly and requires continuous one-on-one facilitation.

Mandatory Curriculum-Context Notice:

This independently prepared professional resource supports the implementation of Kenya's competency-

based curriculum. Teachers should verify grade-specific strands, sub-strands and learning outcomes against the latest official KICD curriculum designs.